

Chapter 5.3

Placarding and marking of cargo transport units and bulk containers

5.3.1 Placarding

5.3.1.1 Placarding provisions

5.3.1.1.1 General provisions

- .1 Enlarged labels (placards) and marks and signs shall be affixed to the exterior surfaces of a cargo transport unit or bulk container to provide a warning that the contents of the unit or bulk container are dangerous goods and present hazards, unless the labels and/or marks affixed to the packages are clearly visible from the exterior of the cargo transport unit or bulk container.
- .2 The methods of placarding and marking as required in 5.3.1.1.4 and 5.3.2 on cargo transport units and bulk containers shall be such that this information will still be identifiable on cargo transport units and bulk containers surviving at least three months' immersion in the sea. In considering suitable marking methods, account shall be taken of the ease with which the surface of the cargo transport unit or bulk container can be marked.
- .3 All placards, orange panels, marks and signs shall be removed from cargo transport units and bulk containers or masked as soon as both the dangerous goods or their residues which led to the application of those placards, orange panels, marks or signs are discharged.

5.3.1.1.2 Placards shall be affixed to the exterior surface of cargo transport units and bulk containers to provide a warning that the contents of the unit are dangerous goods and present hazards. Placards shall correspond to the primary hazard of the goods contained in the cargo transport unit and bulk container except that:

- .1 placards are not required on cargo transport units carrying any quantity of explosives of division 1.4, compatibility group S; and
- .2 placards indicating the highest hazard only need be affixed on cargo transport units carrying substances and articles of more than one division in class 1.

Placards shall be displayed on a background of contrasting colour, or shall have either a dotted or solid outer boundary line.

For dangerous goods of class 9 the placard shall correspond to the label model No. 9 as in 5.2.2.2.2; label model No. 9A shall not be used for placarding purposes.

5.3.1.1.3 Placards shall also be displayed for those subsidiary hazards for which a subsidiary hazard label is required according to 5.2.2.1.2. However, cargo transport units and bulk containers containing goods of more than one class need not bear a subsidiary hazard placard if the hazard represented by that placard is already indicated by a primary hazard placard.

5.3.1.1.4 Placarding requirements

5.3.1.1.4.1 A cargo transport unit or bulk container containing dangerous goods or residues of dangerous goods shall clearly display placards as follows:

- .1 *a freight container, semi-trailer, a closed or sheeted bulk container or portable tank*: one on each side and one on each end of the unit. Portable tanks having a capacity of not more than 3,000 L may be placarded or, alternatively, may be labelled instead, on only two opposite sides;
- .2 *a railway wagon*: at least on each side;
- .3 *a multiple-compartment tank containing more than one dangerous substance or their residues*: along each side at the positions of the relevant compartments. If all compartments are required to display the same placards, these placards need to be displayed only once along each side of the cargo transport unit;
- .4 *a flexible bulk container*: in at least two opposing positions; and
- .5 *any other cargo transport unit*: at least on both sides and on the back of the unit.

5.3.1.1.5 *Special provisions for class 7*

5.3.1.1.5.1 Large freight containers carrying unpackaged LSA-I material or SCO-I or SCO-III or packages other than excepted packages, and tanks, shall bear four placards which conform with the model No. 7D given in the figure. The placards shall be affixed in a vertical orientation to each side wall and each end wall of the large freight container or tank. Any placards which do not relate to the contents shall be removed. Instead of using both labels and placards, it is permitted as an alternative to use enlarged labels only, as shown in label model Nos. 7A, 7B and 7C, except having the minimum size shown in the figure under 5.3.1.2.2.

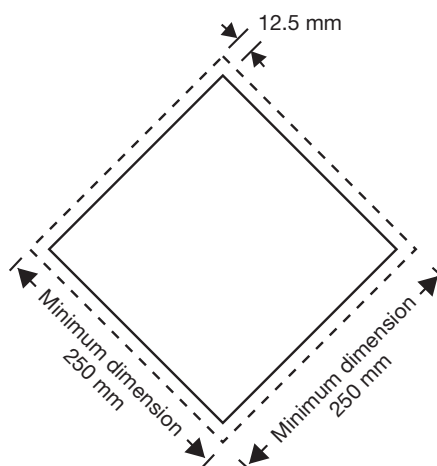
5.3.1.1.5.2 Rail and road vehicles carrying packages, overpacks or freight containers labelled with any of the labels shown in 5.2.2.2.2 as model Nos. 7A, 7B, 7C and 7E, or carrying consignments under exclusive use, shall display the placard shown in the figure (model No. 7D) on each of:

- .1 the two external lateral walls, in the case of a rail vehicle;
- .2 the two external lateral walls and the external rear wall, in the case of a road vehicle.

In the case of a vehicle without sides, the placards may be affixed directly on the cargo-carrying unit provided that they are readily visible; in the case of physically large tanks or freight containers, the placards on the tanks or freight containers shall suffice. In the case of vehicles which have insufficient area to allow the fixing of larger placards, the dimensions of the placard as described in the figure may be reduced to 100 mm. Any placards which do not relate to the contents shall be removed.

5.3.1.2 *Specifications for placards*

5.3.1.2.1 Except as provided in 5.3.1.2.2 for the class 7 placard, and in 5.3.2.3.2 for the marine pollutant mark, a placard shall be configured as shown in the figure below.



Placard (except for class 7)

The placard shall be in the form of a square set at an angle of 45° (diamond-shaped). The minimum dimensions shall be 250 mm × 250 mm (to the edge of the placard). The line inside the edge shall be parallel and 12.5 mm from the outside of that line to the edge of the placard. The symbol and line inside the edge shall correspond in colour to the label for the class or division of the dangerous goods in question. The class or division symbol/ numeral shall be positioned and sized in proportion to those prescribed in 5.2.2.2 for the corresponding class or division of the dangerous goods in question. The placard shall display the number of the class or division (and for goods in class 1, the compatibility group letter) of the dangerous goods in question in the manner prescribed in 5.2.2.2 for the corresponding label, in digits not less than 25 mm high. Where dimensions are not specified, all features shall be in approximate proportion to those shown.

5.3.1.2.2 For class 7, the placard shall have minimum overall dimensions of 250 mm by 250 mm (except as permitted by 5.3.1.1.5.2) with a black line running 5 mm inside the edge and parallel with it, and shall be otherwise as shown in the figure below. When different dimensions are used, the relative proportions shall be maintained. The number “7” shall not be less than 25 mm high. The background colour of the upper half of the placard shall be yellow and of the lower half white; the colour of the trefoil and the printing shall be black. The use of the word “RADIOACTIVE” in the bottom half is optional to allow the use of this placard to display the appropriate United Nations Number for the consignment.